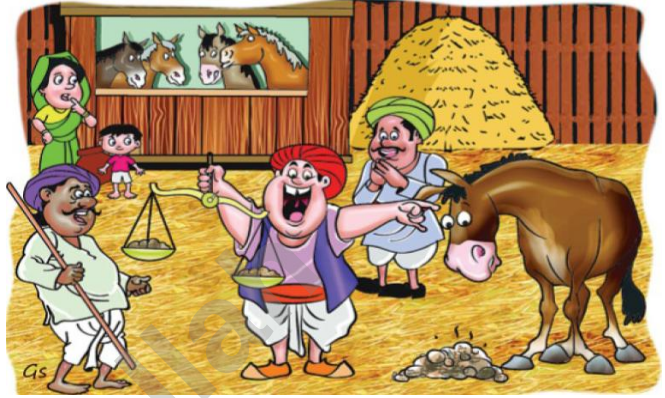


The Clever Merchant

Himanshu was an **arrogant** king. He **harassed** his **subjects** no **end**. In his kingdom was a clever merchant named Gangadhar. The king hated him because he had the **courage** to **stand up to** him.

One day Gangadhar said that a person could **make a living** using his **intelligence**, whatever the **circumstances** or his **predicament**. The king, who was waiting for an opportunity to **put him down**, challenged him to prove it. The king told him that he should earn 1000 gold coins in a month, staying in the **stable** with his family and without **stepping out**.

The merchant agreed. Once in the stable, he started **weighing** the horses' **manure**. He told the **stablehands** who were **amused** by his action that he wanted to check if the horses were **tended to** properly.



Gangadhar found that the manure of some horses weighed less than that of others. He questioned the stablehands. He said if they didn't reveal the truth, he would take the matter to the king. The stablehands then **confessed** that they were selling part of the food meant for the horses in the market. They readily gave their **ill-gotten** money to the merchant, **begging** him not to **spill the beans**. The merchant went to the king with the bag of 1000 gold coins.

"This is for the royal **treasury**. Don't ask me how I managed. I followed the rules and got them by **fair means**." Saying so, he **walked away** leaving the king **dumb-struck**.

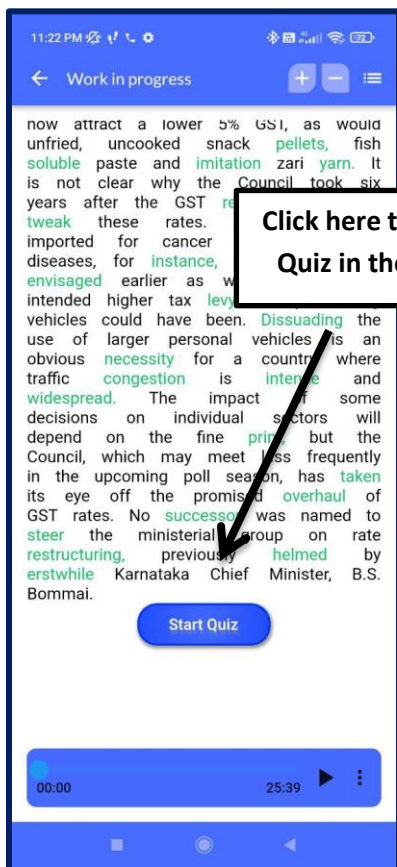
Vocabulary

1. **Clever** (adjective) – intelligent, smart, witty, sharp, resourceful चालाक
2. **Merchant** (noun) – trader, dealer, seller, shopkeeper, vendor व्यापारी
3. **Arrogant** (adjective) – proud, haughty, overconfident, conceited, egoistic घमंडी
4. **Harass** (verb) – trouble, torment, bother, bully, persecute परेशान करना
5. **Subject** (noun) – citizen, resident, inhabitant, populace, people प्रजा
6. **End** (noun) – extent, limit, degree, finish, boundary सीमा / हद
7. **Courage** (noun) – bravery, valor, boldness, fearlessness, determination साहस
8. **Stand up to** (phrase) – confront, oppose, resist, defy, challenge सामना करना
9. **Make a living** (phrase) – earn, survive, generate income, work, subsist आजीविका चलाना
10. **Intelligence** (noun) – intellect, mind, wisdom, cleverness, reasoning बुद्धिमत्ता
11. **Circumstance** (noun) – condition, situation, context, scenario, environment परिस्थिति
12. **Predicament** (noun) – dilemma, difficulty, problem, mess, trouble मुश्किल स्थिति
13. **Put someone down** (phrasal verb) – insult, humiliate, degrade, mock, belittle नीचा दिखाना
14. **Stable** (noun) – barn, shed, stall, cowshed, horse shelter अस्तबल
15. **Step out** (phrasal verb) – go out, exit, leave, walk out, move बाहर जाना
16. **Weigh** (verb) – measure, calculate, assess, balance, quantify तौलना
17. **Manure** (noun) – dung, compost, fertilizer, waste, excrement खाद
18. **Stablehand** (noun) – caretaker, helper, groom, attendant, worker अस्तबल सहायक
19. **Amuse** (verb) – entertain, delight, please, cheer, tickle हँसाना / मनोरंजन करना
20. **Tend** (to) (verb) – take care of, manage, look after, attend, nurture देखभाल करना
21. **Confess** (verb) – admit, reveal, disclose, acknowledge, own up स्वीकार करना
22. **Ill-gotten** (adjective) – dishonestly acquired, illegal, corrupt, unethical, unjust अनुचित ढंग से पाया हुआ
23. **Beg** (verb) – plead, implore, request, entreat, ask विनती करना

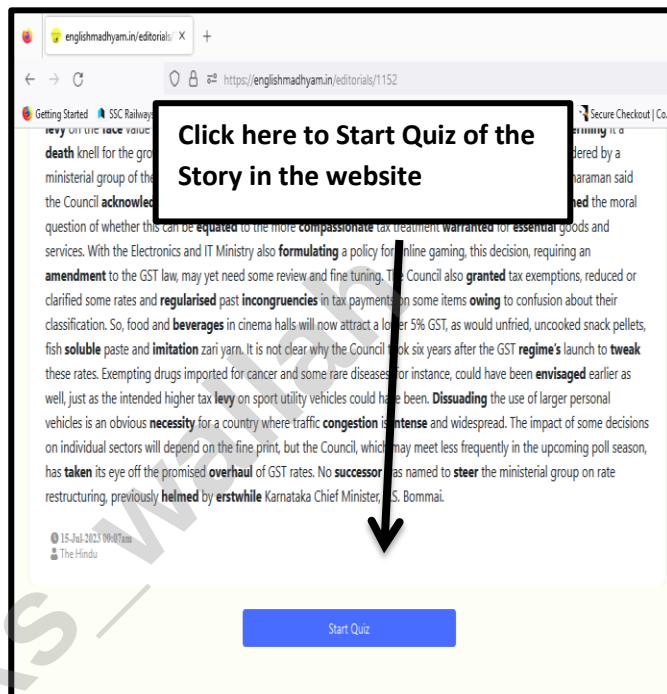
24. **Spill the beans** (phrase) – reveal a secret, confess, disclose, tell the truth, expose राज़ खोलना
25. **Treasury** (noun) – coffer, fund, exchequer, reserve, state bank कोषागार
26. **Fair** (adjective) – just, honest, rightful, unbiased, proper न्यायसंगत
27. **Means** (noun) – method, way, technique, mode, resource साधन
28. **Walk away** (phrasal verb) – leave, exit, withdraw, depart, go away चले जाना
29. **Dumb-struck** (adjective) – speechless, shocked, astonished, stunned, flabbergasted हक्का - बक्का रह जाना

@mocks_wallah

Practice Exercise



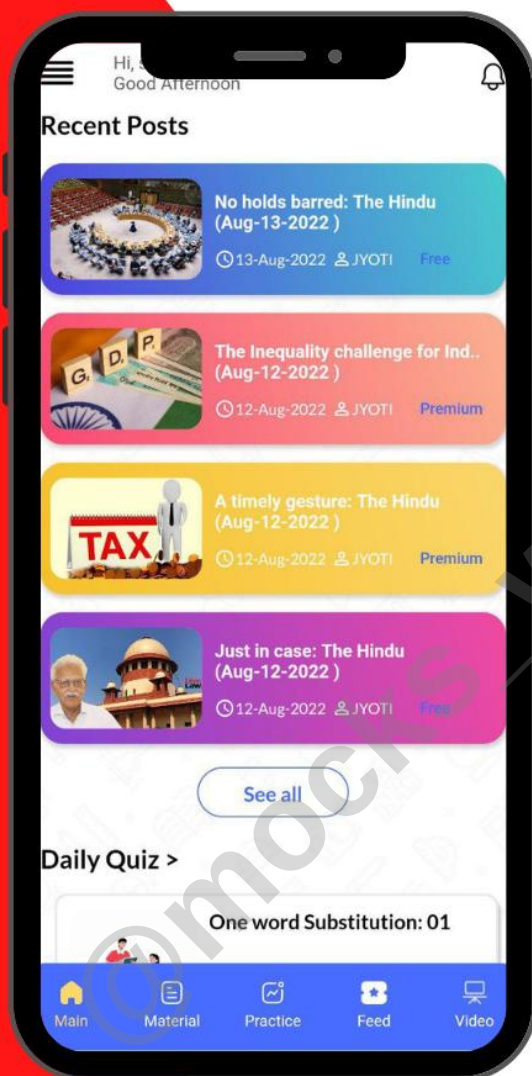
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